

James Belch

Senior Frontend/Full-Stack Engineer

✉ jamesbelchprogramming@gmail.com
🌐 github.com/belch-james
🔗 jamesbelch.pro
📍 Montreal, QC, Canada
☎ +1 (438) 993-3367

Summary

- Senior full-stack engineer with 6+ years delivering production React and API-driven systems in SaaS and internal enterprise platforms. Experienced owning features end-to-end—from architecture and data modeling through deployment, observability, and incident response—supporting large datasets and business-critical workflows.

Technologies

- Frontend: React 18, React Hooks, Next.js (SSR/ISR), TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Vite, HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS, Material UI
- Backend & APIs: Node.js, Express.js, Python (FastAPI), ASP.NET Core, REST APIs, JSON, GraphQL, Authentication (JWT), Authentication (OAuth2), WebSockets, Real-time APIs
- Data & Messaging: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Entity Framework
- DevOps & Tooling: Docker, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), Azure, AWS, Vercel, Linux (Fedora), Jest, Playwright, AI-assisted development: ChatGPT and Claude Code for refactoring support, architectural exploration, and problem decomposition within VS Code-based workflows.
- Automation & RPA: UiPath (RPA), Blue Prism (RPA), Python scripting for automation

Experience

Software Engineer • Invoke Consulting

January 2021 – Present

- Owned end-to-end delivery of full-stack features for a multi-team internal SaaS platform, building React 18 and TypeScript user interfaces and designing FastAPI and ASP.NET Core REST APIs backed by PostgreSQL and Redis to support high-volume, business-critical workflows.
- Designed and implemented a FastAPI-based OCR microservice using Python, EasyOCR, and RESTful endpoints to process PNG and JPG inputs, improving text extraction accuracy by approximately 75% and enabling reliable downstream automation across distributed systems.
- Owned production stability across React, .NET, and Python services, triaging and resolving approximately 25–40 production incidents per month while introducing structured incident response workflows, logging, and monitoring automation that materially reduced mean time to resolution (MTTR).
- Partnered with product managers, data stakeholders, and operations teams to define analytics and reporting requirements, translating business needs into scalable API contracts, data models, and data-heavy frontend views optimized for reliability and maintainability.
- Collaborated with RPA teams using UiPath and Blue Prism to integrate automated workflows into existing systems, reducing manual processing effort, improving data consistency, and increasing operational reliability.
- Contributed to platform scalability and maintainability by reviewing frontend and backend pull requests, enforcing coding standards, and proactively addressing performance, error handling, and observability concerns in production systems.
- Used AI-assisted tooling (ChatGPT, Claude Code) to support refactoring, architectural exploration, and problem decomposition, while retaining manual ownership of design, implementation, and review.

Freelance Developer • Marketplug

October 2018 – August 2019

- Stabilized a production React-based marketplace by diagnosing and resolving critical layout and CSS issues, restoring cross-browser and cross-device UI consistency for active users.
- Refactored legacy class-based React components into modern hook-based patterns using TypeScript, reducing state complexity and improving maintainability and developer velocity.
- Implemented OAuth2 authentication flows (Google and Facebook), coordinating frontend React changes with Node.js and Express backend services to secure JWT-based user sessions.
- Collaborated asynchronously with a distributed team using GitHub pull requests and Slack, clearly communicating trade-offs, reviewing changes, and delivering fixes under tight freelance timelines.

Independent Contractor • Foodora / Uber Eats

February 2015 – June 2021

- Operated reliably in a high-volume, time-sensitive environment, consistently meeting delivery SLAs while maintaining clear communication with customers and platform support teams.

Conductor • CN Rail

February 2008 – September 2014

- Led safety-critical rail-yard operations under strict regulatory constraints, coordinating with dispatch and on-call teams while making sound decisions in high-pressure, time-critical situations.

Education

- LaSalle College, Montreal, Quebec — Diploma in Software Development, 2019–2021
- Graduated with honors while working full-time, focusing on full-stack JavaScript and .NET development.
- Completed a capstone project building a multi-tenant scheduling platform using React, Node.js, and SQL Server.